



SnowPro Core — Full Mock Exam 1 (60 Questions)

PJ's Academy · Timed practice exam matching the real COF-C02 domain ratios.

 **Time limit:** 70 minutes · **Pass mark:** 45/60 (75%) · **No notes.**

Domain mix mirrors the real exam: Architecture 14 Qs · Security 11 · Transformations 13 · Performance/Cost 8 · Loading 6 · Protection/Sharing 8.

Answer all 60, then score with the key at the bottom. Review every wrong answer against the [main guide](#).

Architecture & Features (Q1–Q14)

- Q1.** Snowflake's architecture is best described as: A) Shared-disk B) Shared-nothing C) Multi-cluster shared-data D) Single-node
- Q2.** Which layer manages metadata and query optimization? A) Storage B) Compute C) Cloud Services D) Warehouse
- Q3.** Data in Snowflake is physically stored as: A) Row-based files B) Compressed columnar micro-partitions C) Plain CSV D) B-tree indexes
- Q4.** A virtual warehouse of size Large uses how many credits/hour? A) 2 B) 4 C) 8 D) 16
- Q5.** Multi-cluster warehouses primarily solve: A) Slow single queries B) Concurrency (many users) C) Storage cost D) Data loading
- Q6.** The result cache retains results for: A) 1 hour B) 24 hours C) 7 days D) Until warehouse suspends
- Q7.** Which cache is lost when a warehouse suspends? A) Result cache B) Metadata cache C) Local (warehouse) cache D) None
- Q8.** Which edition first offers 90-day Time Travel and materialized views? A) Standard B) Enterprise C) Business Critical D) VPS
- Q9.** Which is NOT a Snowflake-supported cloud? A) AWS B) Azure C) GCP D) Oracle Cloud
- Q10.** Micro-partitions are approximately what uncompressed size? A) 16 MB B) 50–500 MB C) 1–2 GB D) 10 GB
- Q11.** Pruning improves performance by: A) Compressing data B) Skipping partitions that can't match a filter C) Caching results D) Adding indexes
- Q12.** Snowsight is Snowflake's: A) CLI B) Web UI C) Python connector D) Driver
- Q13.** Which statement about storage and compute is TRUE? A) They scale together B) They are decoupled and scale independently C) Compute includes storage D) Storage requires a running warehouse
- Q14.** Auto-suspend is configured to: A) Drop the warehouse B) Pause a warehouse after idle time C) Resize automatically D) Cache queries

Account Access & Security (Q15–Q25)

- Q15.** In RBAC, privileges are granted directly to: A) Users B) Roles C) Warehouses D) Sessions
- Q16.** Which role is at the top of the hierarchy? A) SYSADMIN B) SECURITYADMIN C) ACCOUNTADMIN D) USERADMIN
- Q17.** Custom roles should be created under which role by best practice? A) ACCOUNTADMIN B) SYSADMIN C) PUBLIC D) ORGADMIN
- Q18.** Which role does every user automatically have? A) SYSADMIN B) PUBLIC C) SECURITYADMIN D) USERADMIN
- Q19.** Dynamic data masking is applied via: A) A view B) A masking policy on a column C) Encryption D) A network policy
- Q20.** Row-level security is implemented with: A) Masking policy B) Row access policy C) Secure view only D) Tags

- Q21.** Data-at-rest encryption in Snowflake is: A) Optional B) Always on (AES-256) C) Business Critical only D) Manual
- Q22.** Tri-Secret Secure requires which edition? A) Standard B) Enterprise C) Business Critical D) All
- Q23.** Network policies control: A) Query cost B) Allowed/blocked IP addresses C) Role hierarchy D) Warehouse size
- Q24.** Which authentication method uses a public/private key? A) Password B) Key-pair authentication C) OAuth D) SAML
- Q25.** Encryption keys in Snowflake rotate automatically every: A) 7 days B) 30 days C) 90 days D) Never

Data Transformations (Q26–Q38)

- Q26.** Which clause filters window-function results without a subquery? A) HAVING B) WHERE C) QUALIFY D) FILTER
- Q27.** Which type stores JSON natively? A) TEXT B) VARIANT C) BLOB D) STRING
- Q28.** To explode a JSON array into rows you use: A) PIVOT B) FLATTEN C) UNNEST D) EXPLODE
- Q29.** `APPROX_COUNT_DISTINCT` is based on which algorithm? A) B-tree B) HyperLogLog C) Bloom filter D) Hash join
- Q30.** To access a nested JSON field you use: A) `col.field` B) `col->field` C) `col:field` D) `col[field]`
- Q31.** Which reshapes rows into columns? A) UNPIVOT B) PIVOT C) FLATTEN D) LATERAL
- Q32.** A view that hides its definition and underlying data is a: A) Standard view B) Materialized view C) Secure view D) Temporary view
- Q33.** Materialized views are available in which edition and above? A) Standard B) Enterprise C) Business Critical D) VPS
- Q34.** `SAMPLE (10)` returns approximately: A) 10 rows B) 10% of rows C) 10 partitions D) Top 10
- Q35.** Which is a Snowflake scalar UDF language? A) Python B) Java C) JavaScript D) All of these
- Q36.** LATERAL FLATTEN is used with which data? A) Structured only B) Semi-structured (arrays/objects) C) Binary D) Numeric
- Q37.** `IFF(condition, a, b)` is: A) A window function B) A conditional (ternary) function C) A join D) An aggregate
- Q38.** To cast a VARIANT value to text you write: A) `::STRING` B) `TO_TEXT()` only C) `CONVERT()` D) `CAST` optional

Performance & Cost (Q39–Q46)

- Q39.** A warehouse spilling to remote disk indicates: A) Too large B) Too small for the workload C) Bad clustering D) Cache full
- Q40.** To cap monthly credit consumption use a: A) Query timeout B) Resource monitor C) Network policy D) Task
- Q41.** Search Optimization Service accelerates: A) Full table scans B) Selective point-lookup queries C) Aggregations D) Joins only
- Q42.** Clustering keys are most beneficial on: A) Small tables B) Very large tables with selective filters C) All tables D) Temporary tables
- Q43.** Which schema holds up to 365 days of account usage data? A) INFORMATION_SCHEMA B) ACCOUNT_USAGE C) PUBLIC D) METADATA
- Q44.** The cheapest way to avoid paying for an idle warehouse: A) Drop it daily B) Set a low `AUTO_SUSPEND` C) Resize to XS D) Use result cache
- Q45.** Which reduces storage cost for a scratch/staging table? A) Permanent table B) Transient table C) Materialized view D) External table
- Q46.** Where do you inspect why a query was slow? A) Query Profile B) Resource monitor C) Network policy D) Snowpipe

Data Loading & Unloading (Q47–Q52)

- Q47.** Which command bulk-loads files into a table? A) INSERT B) COPY INTO C) PUT D) MERGE
- Q48.** Snowpipe is best described as: A) Bulk, warehouse-based B) Continuous, serverless auto-load C) A file format D) A stage type
- Q49.** `@~` refers to which stage? A) Table stage B) Named stage C) User stage D) External stage
- Q50.** `ON_ERROR = 'CONTINUE'` during COPY will: A) Abort B) Skip the file C) Skip bad rows, load the rest D) Retry
- Q51.** Which is NOT a supported load format? A) Parquet B) Avro C) JSON D) DOCX

Q52. To unload query results to files you use: A) COPY INTO B) EXPORT C) DUMP D) UNLOAD

Data Protection & Sharing (Q53–Q60)

Q53. Fail-safe lasts how long and is configurable? A) 1 day, yes B) 7 days, no C) 90 days, yes D) 24 hours, yes

Q54. `UNDROP TABLE` relies on: A) Fail-safe B) Time Travel C) Cloning D) Replication

Q55. Zero-copy cloning consumes storage: A) Immediately B) Only for changed data C) Never D) Double

Q56. Secure Data Sharing gives the consumer: A) A full copy B) Live query access, no copy C) Metadata only D) A reader license

Q57. To share data with a party lacking a Snowflake account: A) Impossible B) Create a reader account C) Email CSVs D) Grant ACCOUNTADMIN

Q58. The Snowflake Marketplace provides: A) Compute credits B) Third-party datasets & data products C) Warehouses D) Courses

Q59. Default Time Travel retention on Standard edition: A) 0 days B) 1 day C) 7 days D) 90 days

Q60. Database replication across regions is used for: A) Cost saving B) Disaster recovery / failover C) Query speed D) Masking

✓ Answer Key

Q	A	Q	A	Q	A	Q	A	Q	A	Q	A
1	C	11	B	21	B	31	B	41	B	51	D
2	C	12	B	22	C	32	C	42	B	52	A
3	B	13	B	23	B	33	B	43	B	53	B
4	C	14	B	24	B	34	B	44	B	54	B
5	B	15	B	25	B	35	D	45	B	55	B
6	B	16	C	26	C	36	B	46	A	56	B
7	C	17	B	27	B	37	B	47	B	57	B
8	B	18	B	28	B	38	A	48	B	58	B
9	D	19	B	29	B	39	B	49	C	59	B
10	B	20	B	30	C	40	B	50	C	60	B

📊 Score Yourself

- **54–60 (90%+):** Exam-ready. Book it. 🎉
- **45–53 (75–89%):** Passing zone — review weak domains, retake.
- **Below 45:** Revisit the [main guide](#), redo practice tests 1 & 2, then retry.

🔁 Tricky Ones to Re-Read

Q6 (result cache 24h), Q7 (local cache lost on suspend), Q53 (fail-safe 7d fixed), Q55 (clone storage), Q39 (spilling = too small), Q17 (custom roles under SYSADMIN). These are the most-missed on the real exam.

